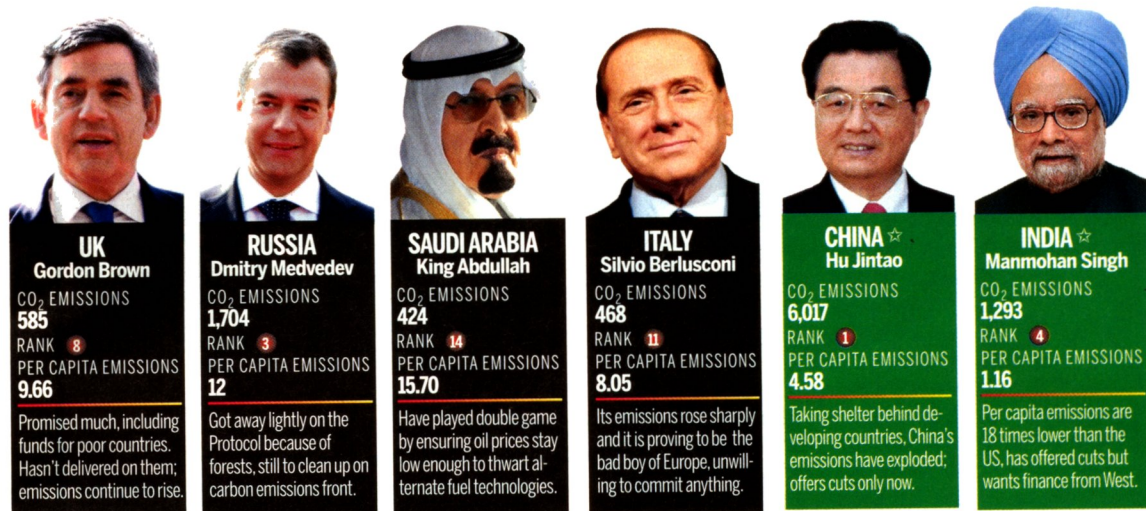




they are not mandated to effect emission cuts



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Protocol were to commit to higher and legally binding cuts in their GHG emissions. These were to cover the second commitment period that was to be from 2012 to 2016. It was a different matter that under the protocol, most of the nations are failing to fulfill their targets in the first commitment period of 2005-2012, in which they were to cut down their GHG emissions to an average 5 per cent less than 1990 levels. Instead, during the period since the UN Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC) was signed in 1992, at the Earth Summit in Rio, the world's GHG emission levels have risen by as much as 30 per cent.

The IPCC had stated that if global temperatures had to be prevented from rising beyond the danger mark of an additional two degrees centigrade, then industrialised nations would have to cut their GHG levels between 25 and 40 per cent below 1990 levels by 2020. What most countries, including the US, are willing to put on the table would amount to barely 5 to 17 per cent of that figure. "Pathetic," is the way Chandrasekhar Dasgupta, India's negotiator describes it. The US, which is Earth's Enemy Number One, when it comes to climate change, after years of refusing to ratify the Kyoto Protocol, finally agreed that it would cut its emissions by up to 17 per cent of 2005 levels. If you calculate that commitment according to the protocol's cut off year of 1990, then it amounts to a meagre four per cent when it should have been triple that.

Worse, since climate change has such a debilitating impact on poor countries, the rich countries were also to fork out hefty sums of money to help them adapt to the adverse conditions. The UNFCCC had estimated that to meet the mitigation and adaption needs for developing countries, the advanced countries should shell out \$400 billion a year. The largest figure mentioned so far is \$100 billion by